

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-III.1: The Independent Reader Workflow

Map an unfamiliar passage, propose lemmas before lookup, and move from analytical reconstruction to direct sense

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

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Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-III.1
Course stage	Stage III — Independent Missal Reading
Prerequisites	EL-II.14 mastery and passage of EL-GATE-II (C-A and delayed C-B)
Observable outcome	Map an unfamiliar passage, propose lemmas before lookup, and move from analytical reconstruction to direct sense
Printed practice	Worksheets III.1 (guided Variant A) and III.4 (cold-read Variant D), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets III.2 and III.3 remain optional lookup-control and reconstruction remediation
Next dependency	EL-III.2, The Ordinary and the Fixed Order

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Learn the three-pass workflow, complete the worked process below, and work Worksheet III.1 without a dictionary for its first five items.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Retrieve the workflow, complete the cold-read Worksheet III.4, audit every lookup, and defend each supply or reconstruction.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: On a fresh 120–180-word passage, mark at least 90% of finite clauses and sampled forms, justify every supply, and consult a dictionary only after recording lemma, morphology, function, and a provisional semantic class.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- frame, dependency, and sense as three distinct passes;
- lemma, morphology, syntax, head, governor, complement, and antecedent;
- prose-order reconstruction as a diagnostic rather than a corrected text; and
- the lookup ledger and five-new-content-word ceiling per hundred words.

2.2 High-risk contrast

A reconstruction groups dependencies for analysis; it does not replace the printed order. A dictionary confirms a proposed lemma and contextual sense; it does not discover the syntax on the learner's behalf.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

The Independent Missal Reader

On completing this unit, you can:

- define a testable meaning of “without a facing translation”;
- read a Missal passage in grammatical passes instead of guessing from memory;
- reconstruct prose order without erasing emphasis;
- use a dictionary only after morphology and clause structure have narrowed the question.

Volume III assumes that the paradigms and syntax of the first two volumes are available from memory. Its task is different: to make those resources operate together on the page of the *Missale Romanum* (1962). A reader who can recite a familiar prayer may still be unable to construe an unfamiliar collect. A reader who can produce an elegant English version may still be unable to say which Latin word governs which. The standard here is therefore visible analysis followed by direct understanding.

For this volume, a **complete Mass** means the fixed prayer text of the *Ordo Missæ* and Roman Canon together with every prayer, lesson, Gospel, and chant text assigned to a particular formulary. It does not mean memorizing rubrics, reading musical notation, or translating the priest’s optional prayers before and after Mass. The *Kyrie* is Greek; Hebrew or Greek liturgical words such as *Amen*, *Alleluia*, and *Hosanna* remain part of the corpus but are not evidence about Latin grammar.

Quoted Missal text follows the 1962 typical edition’s house typography: consonantal *I* in *Iesus*, *eius*, *iustitia*, and the printed ligature *æ*. Other learner editions may expand *æ* to *ae* or print consonantal *j*; those are orthographic variants, not new lemmas. Preserve the source’s spelling when copying, but search a lexicon under its normalized headword when necessary.

Working definitions for independent reading

A **genre** is a recurring class of text identified by its liturgical job and its usual formal features: a Collect and a Gospel may concern the same feast, but they remain different genres because one petitions and the other proclaims a reading. A **formulary** is the set of texts assigned together for one Mass; it can therefore contain several genres.

A **lemma** is the dictionary headword under which an inflected form is listed. **Morphology** identifies what form an ending or stem makes (for example, first-person plural present subjunctive); **syntax** identifies the form’s relation to other words (for example, the finite verb of a purpose clause). A **finite verb** is marked for person and number and can anchor a clause; an infinitive, participle, gerund, or gerundive is **nonfinite** and depends on some larger construction.

A **head** is the central word that a phrase expands. A **governor** is a word or construction that licenses another element, often demanding a case or nonfinite form. A **complement** completes the sense or construction of its governor; a **modifier** adds description without filling such a required slot. An **antecedent** is the expression to which a pronoun or relative refers. **Ellipsis** is the omission of wording recoverable from grammar or strict context; it is not permission to insert whatever makes an English version smooth.

To **construe** a passage is to account for these forms and dependencies so that its sense follows from the Latin. A **prose-order reconstruction** is a temporary diagnostic rearrangement that places dependencies together; it is neither a correction of the source nor a translation.

1.1 What “no facing translation” does and does not mean

It does not forbid English during instruction. A precise translation can expose a false parse. It does forbid using a parallel English column as a substitute for reading during a gate. At a no-facing-translation gate the Latin page is alone. The learner demonstrates understanding by marking clauses, identifying forms, answering short Latin questions, giving a restrained written sense, and explaining the relation of each subordinate clause to its governor.

Familiarity is not the same as sight reading. Accordingly, every final gate has two parts: a familiar text read fluently and an unseen text of the same genre. **Unseen** means not used in the teaching volume or assigned worksheet, although its grammar and high-frequency vocabulary may be familiar.

Three passes through an unfamiliar passage

Pass 1—frame. Circle coordinators and subordinators; underline every finite verb; bracket vocatives and parenthetical *quæsumus*; draw a line after each independent clause. Do not use a dictionary.

Pass 2—dependencies. Mark subjects, direct objects, governed cases, infinitives, participles, and antecedents. Supply an omitted form only in square brackets. Write the supplied Latin, not an English guess.

Pass 3—sense. Read again in the printed order. Consult a dictionary only for a word whose lemma and syntactic slot have already been proposed. Revise the clause map when the proposed meaning does not fit the construction.

1.2 Reconstruction without flattening

Missal word order is meaningful even when it is not the order most convenient for first analysis. Make a disposable prose-order line beneath the text:

1. write the finite verb and its explicit or implicit subject;
2. attach complements demanded by that verb;
3. place modifiers beside their heads;
4. expand subordinate clauses from the outside inward;
5. return to the printed order and state what the displacement emphasizes.

Consider the controlled drill *Tibi, Domine, sacrificium laudis offerimus*, built from recurrent Missal offering diction but not presented as a quotation. Analytical order is *nos offerimus sacrificium laudis tibi, Domine*. The initial *tibi* is not disorder: it foregrounds the recipient. Reconstruction is a scaffold, not a rewritten liturgical text.

1.3 Dictionary discipline

Never look up an inflected form as though it were a lemma. Before opening a dictionary, write four things: proposed lemma, morphology, syntactic function, and a provisional semantic class. For *perfruamur*, for example, write *perfruor, perfrui, perfructus sum; first plural present subjunctive, deponent; verb of the ut-clause; enjoyment/possession; governs ablative*.

During unit work, allow at most five new content-word lookups per one hundred words on the first assisted reading. Function words, endings, and words already entered in the vocabulary ledger do not earn repeat lookups. Record a family, not an orphan: *redimo, redemptio, redemptor; offero, oblatio, munus; salvus, salvo, salus, salutaris*.

Advance when: on an unseen 120–180-word Missal passage, you can mark every finite clause with at least 90% accuracy, identify the lemma and morphology of at least 90% of sampled forms, justify every supplied ellipsis, and state the literal sense with no facing text and no more than five first-pass lookups.

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 What “no facing translation” does and does not mean — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Direct reading is visible analysis before summary, not a ban on English during correction.

Transfer task. Using the first selected worksheet passage, make a no-aid frame map, then write a two-sentence sense only after every finite form and subject is accounted for.

Retrieval check. List three kinds of evidence that distinguish a parse from remembered translation.

1.2 Reconstruction without flattening — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A disposable analytical line must lead back to an observation about the source’s printed order.

Transfer task. Reconstruct the lesson’s project-composed *Tibi, Domine, sacrificium laudis offerimus*; then state what initial *tibi* foregrounds.

Retrieval check. Name one element that reconstruction may move and one that it may never invent.

1.3 Dictionary discipline — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A strong lookup begins with a falsifiable grammatical proposal.

Transfer task. For the lesson’s *perfruamur*, write the four-line pre-lookup hypothesis, check it, and record whether the lexicon changed lemma, construction, or only sense.

Retrieval check. State the condition under which a second lookup of the same content word counts against the ceiling.

Part IV

Selected Practice

CHAPTER 1

Volume III Practice: Independent Missal Reading

The four variants under each unit are interchangeable. Complete any two before the unit gate; use the others for remediation or delayed retrieval. Unless a prompt explicitly permits a dictionary, make a complete first-pass clause map before consulting one. All cited liturgical text is from the *Missale Romanum* (1962).

Unit III.1 — Reading Method and Dictionary Discipline

III.1 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.1

Focus: Clause frames before vocabulary

Use: Map first; no dictionary for Items 1–5.

1. In *Dominus vobiscum*, state the conventional optative construal and identify *vobiscum*.

2. In the controlled word-order drill, underline the finite verb and attach every dependent in *Tibi, Domine, sacrificium laudis offerimus*.

3. Reconstruct *Puris mereamur mentibus introire* in analytical order, then state what may not be omitted.

4. Classify the supply in *lex Dei eius in corde ipsius [est]* as grammatical, parallel, or interpretive and justify it.

5. Explain why capital letters cannot decide the syntax of *Salvatorem germinet terra*.

6. **Text:** *Vias tuas, Domine, notas fac mihi: et semitas tuas edoce me.*
Passage ID: III.1.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Make a clause map, prose-order line, and literal sense; no dictionary.

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction's rule.

III.1 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.4

Focus: Cold-read gate rehearsal

Use: No lookup until the final item.

1. **Text:** *Largire nobis, quæsumus, Domine, semper spiritum cogitandi quæ recta sunt, propitius et agendi: ut, qui sine te esse non possumus, secundum te vivere valeamus.*

Passage ID: III.4.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Mark every clause, nonfinite form, and antecedent.

-
2. Write the minimum prose-order reconstruction of the passage.

-
3. In simple Latin answer: *Quid Dominus largiri rogatur?*

-
4. In simple Latin answer: *Cur auxilio Domini egemus?*

-
5. State the function of *propitius*; give one defensible English sense without rearranging it into a separate clause.

-
6. Now permit two lookups. Which entries, if any, materially improve the parse rather than merely polish English?
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Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction's rule.

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

What “no facing translation” does and does not mean — model and rubric

Connection. Direct reading is visible analysis before summary, not a ban on English during correction.

Model / acceptable evidence. A complete model marks coordinators, finite verbs, subjects, governed forms, and any bracketed supply before giving sense. Accept morphology, clause attachment, and reference as the three evidence kinds; familiarity alone is not evidence.

Reconstruction without flattening — model and rubric

Connection. A disposable analytical line must lead back to an observation about the source's printed order.

Model / acceptable evidence. Model: *Nos offerimus sacrificium laudis tibi, Domine.* The reconstruction groups verb, subject, object, genitive, and recipient; the return pass notes the foregrounded recipient. Words may move, but absent content may not be invented.

Dictionary discipline — model and rubric

Connection. A strong lookup begins with a falsifiable grammatical proposal.

Model / acceptable evidence. The model proposes *perfruor*; first plural present subjunctive deponent; verbal center of its clause; enjoyment/possession governing an ablative. A repeated ledger word counts again when the learner failed to retain or recognize it.

CHAPTER 3

Selected worksheet solutions

CHAPTER 4

Volume III Practice: Independent Missal Reading

The four variants under each unit are interchangeable. Complete any two before the unit gate; use the others for remediation or delayed retrieval. Unless a prompt explicitly permits a dictionary, make a complete first-pass clause map before consulting one. All cited liturgical text is from the *Missale Romanum* (1962).

Unit III.1 — Reading Method and Dictionary Discipline

III.1 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.1

Focus: Clause frames before vocabulary

Use: Map first; no dictionary for Items 1–5.

1. In *Dominus vobiscum*, state the conventional optative construal and identify *vobiscum*.
Answer / model: An interpretive pedagogical paraphrase is *[sit] Dominus vobiscum*; *sit* is not expressed or uniquely forced by morphology. *vobiscum* is *cum* with ablative second-person plural pronoun; the phrase is comitative. Supplying *est* would not preserve the conventional optative force.
2. In the controlled word-order drill, underline the finite verb and attach every dependent in *Tibi, Domine, sacrificium laudis offerimus*.
Answer / model: Finite verb: *offerimus*; implicit subject *nos*; object *sacrificium*; dependent genitive *laudis*; recipient *tibi*; vocative *Domine*.
3. Reconstruct *Puris mereamur mentibus introire* in analytical order, then state what may not be omitted.
Answer / model: Analytical order: *mereamur introire puris mentibus*. *mereamur* is first plural present subjunctive deponent and requires complementary infinitive *introire*; *puris mentibus* is ablative of attendant manner.
4. Classify the supply in *lex Dei eius in corde ipsius [est]* as grammatical, parallel, or interpretive and justify it.
Answer / model: I: the printed text is a verbless nominal clause with a prepositional location predicate. *[est]* is an interpretive dependency or English paraphrase; Latin does not require an overt copula, and no additional content word may be supplied.
5. Explain why capital letters cannot decide the syntax of *Salvatorem germinet terra*.
Answer / model: Case endings decide it: nominative *terra* is subject; accusative *Salvatorem* object; third-person singular subjunctive *germinet* agrees with *terra*. Capitals are editorial/devotional.
6. **Text:** *Vias tuas, Domine, notas fac mihi: et semitas tuas edoce me*.
Passage ID: III.1.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Make a clause map, prose-order line, and literal sense; no dictionary.
Answer / notes: Two coordinated imperatives: *fac* and *edoce*, implicit divine subject. Prose order: *Domine, fac vias tuas notas mihi et edoce me semitas tuas*. *notas* is predicate accusative; *mihi* dative; *me* object. Sense: make your ways known to me and teach me your paths.

III.1 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.4

Focus: Cold-read gate rehearsal

Use: No lookup until the final item.

1. **Text:** *Largire nobis, quæsumus, Domine, semper spiritum cogitandi quæ recta sunt, propitius et agendi: ut, qui sine te esse non possumus, secundum te vivere valeamus.*

Passage ID: III.4.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Mark every clause, nonfinite form, and antecedent.

Answer / notes: Main petition *largire* with recipient *nobis* and object *spiritum*; genitive gerunds *cogitandi* ... *et agendi* depend on *spiritum*; *quæ recta sunt* is a substantival relative, object of both gerunds by sense. Result/purpose *ut* ... *valeamus*; embedded substantival *qui* has antecedent implicit *nos*; infinitives *esse* and *vivere* complement *possumus/valeamus*.

2. Write the minimum prose-order reconstruction of the passage.

Answer / model: *Domine, propitius largire nobis semper spiritum cogitandi et agendi quæ recta sunt, ut nos, qui sine te esse non possumus, valeamus secundum te vivere.*

3. In simple Latin answer: *Quid Dominus largiri rogatur?*

Answer / model: *Rogatur ut nobis spiritum recta cogitandi et agendi largiatur.*

4. In simple Latin answer: *Cur auxilio Domini egemus?*

Answer / model: *Auxilio eius egemus quia sine eo esse non possumus.*

5. State the function of *propitius*; give one defensible English sense without rearranging it into a separate clause.

Answer / model: Predicate adjective with the implicit subject of *largire*, used with adverbial force: “being gracious/graciously grant.” It is not an adverbial form morphologically.

6. Now permit two lookups. Which entries, if any, materially improve the parse rather than merely polish English?

Answer / model: A prepared reader needs none. If needed, *largior*, *largiri*, *largitus sum* confirms a deponent imperative, and *secundum* confirms accusative *te*. Looking up *recta* before recognizing substantival neuter plural would not be disciplined.

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-III.1, *The Independent Reader Workflow*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. This packet establishes the independent-reading process; it does not by itself demonstrate sustained reading of a complete formulary.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source

roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T21:47:58Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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